



YTA Yoga Tantra & Agama

Newsletter

Volume 6, Issue: 19

Jan–March 2020

ISSN No. 2454-888x

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From the Chief Editor's Desk



Five Routines and the Ripple-less Assimilation

In the agamic pursuits, attitude or चर्या is as significant as the practice itself. The five *charya* or routines viz. अनाश्रित(unsupported), अवधूत(pure), उन्मत्त (mad monk), महाव्यापक(omnipresent), सर्वभक्ष्य (omnivorous); apparently understood as the conduct or daily practice of an aspirant are meant in a very subtle and esoteric sense. The adept who is required to maintain these has already been redeemed from the conventional routine as he is able to shred the conditioning of नियति or limited doer ship. All these five attitudes are *a posteriori* of ones having assimilated the objective phenomena into his essential nature which is pure subjective awareness. *Anashrita* is the ultimate and all pervasive substratum with nothing else on which to be caricatured. This has been explained by an ant-Shakti as compared to the subtle most ether. There are three gradations of subtlety of “ear” or hearing. The gross one is ordinary audible phenomena, the subtler one as on canon on Tantras says comes from indepth study and erudition specially pertaining to mystic and arcane type. The subtle-most ear is generated by the mystic practice of listening to “eternal word of God ” or the unstuck and thus spontaneous nada(नाद) .

There are two more gradations of this ethereal realm which lie within the domain of empirical and universal self and are usually referred to as चिदाकाश (the ether of consciousness) and परमाकाश the ultimate or universal ether. The former two called gross material and mental ethers (स्थूलाकाश, चित्ताकाश) whereas the third and the fourth one pervade the domain of an empirical and universal self which dissolves the entire conditioned and unconditioned objectivity (चिदाकाश, परमाकाश). *Avadhoota* is a sect of mendicants who are apparently free from all cloister-obligation and ecclesiastical restrictions. Term mindset चर्या or attitude in this parlance is highly esoteric. The name is merely owing to some semblance. Owing to these unregulated and free out-flux vision (दृक्शक्ति) is divergent only to pervade and then dissolve the entire objectivity . उन्मत्त literally the insane, is in fact the state of supramental awareness in which both subjective and objective awareness is concomitantly absorbed irrespective of any order like objective awareness first into subjectivity which in turn leads to an unconditioned awareness, undivided into subjective or objective portions and so on. Omnivorous attitude devours even the impressions of objectivity

metaphorically named as food or भक्ष्यं, an innate impulse of assimilating all objective conditioning comprising names and forms. The all pervasive state (सर्वव्यापक) has been explained by conceptualising two entities- the pervaded and the pervasive. Touch, the attribute of air which is related to tactile perception is the pervaded and the subtler ether pervades. The tactile perception is also called *prana*. It pervades the entire phenomena. Vedas mention it as सूत्रात्मा or the “string soul”. It interlaces all sentient creatures beginning from god, the creator upto a small iota of creation . This सूत्रात्मा in an individual subtle body is called लिंगशरीरम्. Since the prana interlaces the subtle body only of one individual and for that matter लिंगशरीरम् of all entities including हिरण्यगर्भ or Brahma the creator, harming *prana* is a sin. Hurting the प्राण of an individual is hurting the प्राण interlacing the entire universe . This is the rationale of an ancient adage “पापाय परपीडनम्”i.e. it is a sin to hurt anyone -hurting someone is hurting everyone !

Realisation of otherwise innate unison with the all-pervasive principle is the attitude of सर्वव्यापक or the all- pervasive one . All उपाय like अनुपाय, आणवशांभव and शाक्त etc. are like ripples in the eternally placid and quiet waters of the ultimate consciousness . All movements arising from “efforts” cease, as the intuitive insight into the spontaneously innate and essentially unperturbed awareness of one’s own *shivahood* is realised. The ripple-less assimilation into one’s essential nature cannot be attained through any *upaya* or means. The ultimate in this mystic cult is discarding all *upayas* or tactics. Ashtavakra, the sage instructs his disciple King Janaka- O!Janaka, your bondage is due to your striving for your essential nature (अयमेव हि ते बन्धःसमाधिमनुतिष्ठसि/ (ayameva hi te baṁdhah samādhimanutiṣṭhasi).

The more you strive the more you deviate from essential nature.

उपायजालं न शिवंप्रकाशयेत् घटेन किं भाति सहस्रदीधितिः,

(upāyajālaṁ na śivaṁprakāśayet ghaṭena kiṁ bhāti sahasradīdhitiḥ)

Trans: Just as the sun is not visible in the light of a pitcher, Shiva cannot be evident through any tactics or knack . He is self-evident .

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Ādi Śaṅkara's View on Creation in accordance with the Vedas and Agamas*

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ABSTRACT

Adi Shankara, the exponent of monistic Vedanta has also authenticated agamas as the means of salvation for aspirants of meager competence. The most significant treatise on the mode of creation is "Panchikaranam". Since the creation is virtual and superimposed, the mode or process is depicted merely to facilitate the assertion of the substratum by negating the superimposed phenomena. The process of creation in "Panchikaranam Vartikam" of Sureshwaracharya is similar to the one given by Punyanand Nath in his tantrik canon "Kamakala Vilasa". Verses from "Saundaryalahari" of Shri Shankara explain the power and process of creation in agamic way as he felicitates the divine mother. Ajatvada is the ultimate consummation of Shankarite monism. According to this theory nothing originates even for elimination. The phenomena is apparent and virtual and the Brahman as one without a second is the ultimate truth. This however requires very high competence of dispassion and wisdom. The illustrious acharya out of sheer compassion and munificence devised agamic and tantrik means for the redemption of aspirants with deficit competence. These explain the power and process of creation in an agamic or Tantrik manner i.e. as emanating from Shiv -Shakti conjugal pair.

Keywords : Agama, Ajatavada ,Axiom of assertion and negation, Kamakala Nigamas, Panchikaranam, particulars (visesa), Trivritkaranam.

Introduction

All philosophic doctrines invariably depict the power and process of creation. The exposition of the power and process of creation and its relation with creator, real, virtual nature of creation or otherwise is the first and foremost proposition of all schools of thought. Owing to its being superimposed on the absolute principle as the substratum, the school of

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monism refutes the eternal and real nature of the phenomena. Therefore, the metaphysical portion of the Vedas or the Upaniṣads do not emphasize

on describing the power and process of creation. Notwithstanding the creation has been depicted by ancient seers from the stand point of supposition and elimination or अध्यारोपापवादन्याय.

The main purpose of describing the process of creation in various ways in the Upaniṣadas is primarily to ascertain the nature of the absolute principle by eliminating all the phenomena which is superimposed on it. This explains why there are various theories about the process of creation in the Upaniṣadas. Since the phenomena are to be proven as virtual and superimposed by the Upaniṣadas, the description of creation is fruitful only in as much as the axiom of inferring the cause by analyzing attributes of the effect. e.g. –

तेजसाशुंगेनसोम्यसन्मूलमन्विच्छेत्¹

O! Benign one investigate the root by inspecting the stub

i.e. guess the cause by inspecting the effect.

Gaudapada Acharya, the exponent of monism has aptly put it in –

मृल्लोहविस्फुलिङ्गाद्यैः सृष्टिर्याचोदितान्वया।

उपायः सोऽवतारायनास्तिभेदः कथञ्चन॥²

The description of creation by examples of clay, iron or sparks in various Upaniṣadic mantras is merely to facilitate the comprehension of the acolyte and need not be exact.

Hence the main purpose of describing the power and process of creation is to cogitate upon the absolute principle and in a strict monistic sense as the universal self. In this paper we shall depict the process of creation from the viewpoints of *nigama* i.e. the Vedas and agama or the tantras as per the doctrine of Ādi Śaṅkarācārya in *Pañcīkaraṇam* and *Saundaryalaharī* etc.

Pañcīkaraṇam

This is one of the foremost methods of monistic *vedānta* when it comes to describing the process of universal manifestation. while depicting the order of creation the revelations say that as the lord unites with his *māyā* just by his *saṅkalpa* or conceptualizing the subtle phenomena comprising five perceptions originates which is the state of the phenomena *a priori* to

¹ छान्दोग्योपनिषद् ६.८.६

² माण्डूक्योपनिषद् – गौडपादकारिका ३.१५

the process of *pañcīkaraṇam* (fivefold combination). These five elementary constituents of the universal phenomena arise from the *māyā*. These three *gunas* are the three aspects of nature or *prakṛti*. The *tamas* or inert portions of all elements like ether etc. are united with other portions of other elements. In this manner from *apañcīkṛtabhūtāni* (subtle combined elements) which are united with *tamoguṇa* or the character of inertia, the gross combined elements spring forth. This happens in the following manner.

Each one of the five elements divides into two portions. One portion is filled with the main element. The remaining portion further divides into four and the preceding half of each element unites with the remaining four parts. In this way all five elements imbibe the attributes of all other elements and one major part remains the main characteristics of each one of them, owing to the abundance of their respective characteristics the five elements exhibit their own primary characteristics.³

This conversion of subtle phenomena into the grosser form is to be meditated upon. From the gross combined five elements the entire universe is generated.⁴

Here, some thinkers opine that if all this is only *pañcīkaraṇam* or the fivefold combination and permutation then of what avail are the other mantras like - तासां त्रिवृतं त्रिवृतमेकैकांकरवाणि।⁵

इदं तेज इमा अप इदमन्नम्, This mantra specifies particulars or *viśeṣa* and how they originate in the five elementary constituents of the universal phenomena. Answering the aphorism of *Brahman* says - वैशेष्यात्तु तद्वादस्तद्वादः (2/4/11) this method of *trivṛtkaraṇam* or tripartite mutation and combination is to facilitate the process. In the gross element of fire we have an abundance of the portion of fire, in water there is an excess of the subtle water, so on and so forth.

Thus, despite the process of *trivṛtkaraṇam* owing to ‘speciality’ or ‘particularity’ this opinion of particulars pertaining to the five *mahābhūtāni* and their produces of *teja*, *ap* and *anna* etc. are consistent. This very theory has been elaborated by Śaṅkarācārya and Sureśvarācārya in his

³ तत्राकाशस्य स्वार्धेन भूतान्तरादागतपादचतुष्केण च पञ्चीकरणम् (ब्र०सू०शा०भा० १.१.४); ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यम् - भामतीकल्पतरुपरिमलोपेतम्, भगवान् आदिशङ्कराचार्यः, सं० अनन्तकृष्णशास्त्रिभिरुपस्कृतम्, चौखम्बासंस्कृतसीरीज्, वाराणसी, वि०सं० - २००३ [पृ०सं० १००]

⁴ वेदान्तपरिभाषा - समणिप्रभा

⁵ छान्दोग्योपनिषद्

Pañcikaraṇam and *Vārtikam* respectively. This has been exhaustively discussed in संज्ञामूर्तिकृत्यधिकरणम्⁶.

The Process of Creation as Depicted In *Pañcikaraṇam*

This brief passage is considered as the most important among all auxiliary works of ĀdiŚaṅkarācārya. Despite the name *Pañcikaraṇam* which literally means to elaborate or expand, this brief canon doesn't have expansion or Pentad- dimensional reciprocation of the phenomena as it propounds. The main objective of this work is not to explain the process of creation but to convey the esoteric meaning of *praṇava* or *onkāra* and to facilitate the process of seating in the essential nature by cloistered monks. This has been enunciated in the beginning itself -

अथातः परमहंसानांसमाधिविधिंव्याख्यास्यामः⁷ ***

ओङ्कारःसर्ववेदानांसारतत्त्वप्रकाशकः।
तेनचित्तसमाधानंमुमुक्षूणांप्रकाशयते॥⁸

Onkāra illuminates the essential nature of all the Vedas.

We shall impart the knowledge of as to how an aspirant after emancipation should pacify his mind by meditating upon its meaning.*

It is obligatory for a monk to recite and practice this method during the three seance of morning, midday and evening.

इमांविद्यांप्रयत्नेनयोगीसन्ध्यासुसर्वदा।
समभ्यसेदिहामुत्रभोगनासक्तधीसुधी॥⁹

A learned Yogi who is dispassionate towards enjoyments of this world and world beyond i.e. heaven etc. and has refined his intellect, should practice this knowledge thrice a day i.e. in the morning, noon and evening.

There are six various expositions of this small passage. *Pañcikaraṇavārtikam*, *Pañcikaraṇavivaraṇam*, *Pañcikaraṇabhāvaṇaprakāśikā* and *Pañcikaraṇavyākhyā* attributed to - Sureśvarācārya, Ānandagiri, Abhinavanārāyaṇendra and some anonymous author. This explains the importance of this concise work of just one passage. In this treatise the process of creation has been depicted in just five sentences, as follows :

⁶ ब्रह्मसूत्रभाष्यम् २.४.९

⁷ पञ्चीकरणवार्तिकम्

⁸ पञ्चीकरणवार्तिकम्

⁹ पञ्चीकरणवार्तिकम्

ओंसच्छब्दवाच्यमविद्याशबलं ब्रह्म। ब्रह्मणोऽव्यक्तम्। अव्यक्तात्महत्। महतोऽहङ्कारः। अहङ्कारात्पञ्चतन्मात्राणि। पञ्चतन्मात्रेभ्यः पञ्चमहाभूतानि। पञ्चमहाभूतेभ्योऽखिलं जगत्।¹⁰

The Process of Creation In *Saundaryalaharī*

From an agamic perspective this is the play of *kāmakalā* or the primordial will of the universal being. This *kāmakalā* manifests in the form of *vimarśasakti* or gnosis and is inseparable from the Lord. Her blissful sporting is the very function of creation. This has been illustrated in *Lalitāsahasranāma*, काम्याकामकलारूपादम्बकुसुमप्रिया etc. The transcendental *śakti* assimilates the entire phenomena consisting of thirty-six elements. She rests in her spiritual magnanimity for a considerable period, after devouring the entire objectivity like a morsel. When the time for creation is ripe according to the collective destiny or *prārabdha* of beings to be created the lord looks into his own image within the shakti who is comparable to a looking glass. Then the lord cognizes his essential nature and grandeur, this generates in him the desire to create the universe this” desire to create is termed as *kāma*. This leads to an upsurge of *kriya*. This mystery has been aptly described by Punyananand Nath in there very first canto of his canon named *Kāmakalāvilāsa* or the sporting of the divine will,

सकलभुवनोदयस्थितिलयमयलीलाविनोदनोद्युक्तः।
अन्तर्लीनिविमर्शःपातुमहेशःप्रकाशमात्रतनुः॥

May Maheśa the lord who is of the nature of effulgence and is always engrossed in the gnosis of his nature be our succor.

He plays the game of creating, sustaining and terminating the entire universal phenomena out of his sheer will.

ĀdiŚaṅkarācārya has propounded the process of creation in many verses of *Saundaryalaharī*. This has been elaborately depicted in the exposition by Lakṣmīdhara. We are mentioning them in the order of relevance in this paper. The very first verse has this process encrypted in it. It attributed the agency of creation to *Śiva* and *Śakti* who are inseparable. *Śakti* in context is the power of creative flutter which is seated in *Śiva*. This verse composed in the felicitation of *Śakti* only enunciates the principle of the agamas. In the next verse the creation etc. has been explained as originating from the minute dust particle from the feet of the divine mother. The universe has been conceptualized as pervaded by *Śiva* and *Śakti* in yet another verse

¹⁰ पञ्चीकरणवार्तिकम्

चतुर्भिः श्रीकण्ठैःशिवयुवतिभिःपञ्चभिरपि
प्रभिन्नाभिःशम्भोर्नवभिरपिमूलप्रकृतिभिः।

चतुश्चत्वारिंशद्वसुदलकलाश्रत्रिवलय-
त्रिरेखाभिःसार्धतवशरनकोणाःपरिणताः॥

In this verse the union of *Śakti* and *Śiva* is explained as nine-fold nature or Prakriti according to their configuration in the diagrammatic instrument called *Śrīcakram*.

Five inverted triangles are the semiotic depiction of *Śakti* and the four triangles pointing upwards represent *Śiva*, taken together these are nine triangles which have been termed as *mūlaprakṛtiḥ* or the primordial nature by ĀdiŚaṅkarācārya.

In the gross body; skin, flesh, fat and bones have their origin in *śakti* whereas marrow, semen, vital air or *prañā* and *jīva* originate from *Śiva* so the microcosm is an embodiment of *Śiva* and *Śakti* the macrocosm being identical with the microcosm is also the same i.e. a unison of *Śiva* and *Śakti*.

पञ्चभूतानिशाक्तानिमायदीनिशिवस्यतु।
मायाचशुद्धविद्याचमहेश्वरसदाशिवौ॥

Five *bhūtāni* or the elementary constituents of the phenomena belong to *Śakti* and four constituents- *māyā*, *śuddhavidyā*, *maheśvara* and *sadāśiva* belong to *Śiva*.

In this way *Śiva* and *Śakti* union has been propounded as the primeval cause of this universe. Sustenance or the regulation of the universal order is also attributed to *Śakti* and her ordinance in the following 24th verse.

Whole universe has been depicted in the thirty sixth verse, as a modification of *Śakti* which is also an arcane principle of the agamas. In a hymn called *Catuśśatī*, this very phenomena has been described.

शृणुदेविमहाज्ञानंसर्वज्ञानोत्तमंप्रिये।
येनविज्ञानमात्रेणभवाब्धौननिमज्जति॥
त्रिपुरापरमाशक्तिराद्याजातामहेश्वरि।
स्थूलसूक्ष्मविभागेनत्रैलोक्योत्पत्तिमातृका॥
कवलीकृतनिःशेषतत्त्वग्रामस्वरूपिणि।
यस्यांपरिणतायांतुनकिञ्चित्परिमिष्यते॥

(चतुःशती)

(O goddess listen to the best among wisdoms from me just by knowing this a man doesn't drown in the ocean of worldly existence . In the beginning there was the primordial power, Shakti or Shakti named Shri Tripursundari .She incarnates in the form of alphabet and accounts for the creation of all three realms .At the time of dissolution, she assimilates the entire phenomena comprising thirty-six elementary constituents or तत्त्वग्राम. In this stage there is no entity which can be beyond her i.e. she is the ultimate).

The purport of this hymn is explained in the gloss by Lakṣmīdhara - The cluster of *tattvas* which is dormant in her in the causal state like “earth in a jar as its essential component “are completely devoured by her. Having assimilated the objective phenomena in toto, she stays in her essential nature. She stays as the essence of cause after having assimilated the entire effect part of the phenomena in the causal state.

Since the universe is an offspring of *Siva* and *Śakti*, it is not orphan but it's guardianship is attributed to *Siva* and *Śakti*, the following verse explains just this -

तवाधारेमूलेसहसमययालास्यपरया
नवात्मानंमन्येनवरसमहाताण्डवनटम्।
उभाभ्यामेताभ्यामुदयविधिमुद्दिश्यदयया
सनाथाभ्यांजज्ञेजनकजननीमज्जगदिदम्॥

In the verse “तवाज्ञाचक्रे...”, the order of successive creation and dissolution of the penta-dimensional phenomena to be meditated upon in the *ājñācakra*- the psychic plexus between the eye brows. The tantric meditation on the convergent and divergent modes of creation and dissolution as per the agamas has its origin in the Vedas.

From that universal self, the ether was created and from that ether; air and so on, “तस्माद्वाएतस्मादात्मनआकाशःसम्भूतः”. Therefore, while felicitating the divine mother with this verse, ĀdiŚaṅkarācārya aims at the reconciliation of both principles of the Vedas as well as that of the Āgamas. Hence in his lucid style the illustrious Ācārya has reconciled the procedure of Āgama and Nigama i.e. Veda and Tantra.

One verse describes the agencies of creation viz. *Brahma*, *Viṣṇu* and *Rudra Īśvara* and *Sadāśiva* as subservient to commands displayed by a slight movement of the eye brows of the supreme mother. In yet another canto, the Ācārya while felicitating the eyes of the divine mother says that

her blinking of the eyes dissolves the entire universe and opening creates them. In order to prevent this from happening untimely, she always has her eyes wide open.

निमेषोनिमेषाभ्यांप्रलयमुदयंयातिजगती

***Ajātavāda* - The Theory of No Birth**

Having propounded the virtual nature of the universal phenomena, ĀdiŚaṅkarācārya has depicted the power and process of creation in both ways i.e. according to the Vedas and as well as the agamas. *Ajātavāda* is the consummation of Monistic doctrine of ĀdiŚaṅkarācārya. This doctrine refutes even the origin of any other objective entity. In the lineage of *advaita*, this theory of "no origin" is the most significant. This however is consistent only in the case of aspirants of very high competence i.e. those who are absolutely dispassionate and have inculcated a very sharp discriminatory wisdom. This doctrine has been propounded particularly in the compendium called *Māṇḍūkya-kārikā* compiled by Gauḍapādācārya. According to the adage of conceptualizing objectivity in the absolute subjective consciousness, Brahman is to facilitate its negation. The *vedānta* do not primarily propound the process of creation but to convey the concept of Brahman as the substratum of the superimposed phenomena. The process of elimination of the supposed phenomena is explained. So, comparatively the ultimate is *ajātavāda* or the Theory of "No Birth" since as a proverb goes it's better not to soil one's hands than to soil them and then wash.

In the theory of *ajātavāda*, there is no origin of any entity theoretically or in actuality. The universal Brahman alone is the existent entity and no other entity ever originated. Even the empirical soul, or the objective phenomena has no origin as the *karika* goes :

ननिरोधोनचोत्पत्तिर्नबद्धोनचसाधकः।

नमुमुक्षुर्नवैमुक्तइत्येषापरमार्थता॥

The essence of this *kārika* is that there is no *nirodha* i.e. no dissolution since there is no creation and dissolution. From an absolute perspective nobody is bound nor liberated .

The notion of creation is only for depicting the monistic nature of the self. In the commentary "the way the mantras pertaining to *prana* aim at propounding the nature of the self- "प्राणसंवाद". This speaks for the theory of *ajātavāda* as the ultimate postulation to ascertain the absolute truth. In the commentary on the *kārika*, it has been answered that how can there be an absence of creation and dissolution. This is owing to the virtuality of

duality and this has been reinforced by citing many mantras from the Upaniṣadas.

The phenomenal universe appears as dual and only objectivity i.e. different from the subjective conscious substratum appears.

Non-dualist and reality of the phenomena cannot be concomitant. Just as the notions like "superimposed serpent in a rope etc. neither originate nor disappear". Since there is no creation or dissolution of a superimposed phenomena their virtual disposition is like visions in a dream. There is a mantra in *Māṇḍūkya Upaniṣada*.

स्वप्नमायेयथादृष्टेगन्धर्वनगरं यथा।
तथाविश्वमिदं दृष्टं वेदान्तेषु विचक्षणैः॥

To a man of erudition in *vedānta* the entire universal phenomena is like a conjure's trick, dream or a mirage appearing like a town.

स्वप्नजागरितः स्थाने ह्येकमाहुर्मनीषिणः।
भेदानां हि समत्वेन प्रसिद्धे नैव हेतुना॥

The illusory nature of the universe is akin to that of a dream. Both have been categorized as similar because of their being similar, in as much as they have duality in common.

Another mantra from *Annapūrnopaniṣada* depicts that, the main proposition of all spiritual revelations is rejection of all duality by ascertaining that there is no nescience (अविद्या) or delusion (माया). In this Upaniṣada, the virtuality of all subjective, objective and their experience etc. has been propounded.

Adhyātmopaniṣadśruti also proclaims the supremacy of *ajātavāda*

असत्कल्पो विकल्पोऽयं विश्वमित्येकवस्तुनि।
निर्विकारे निराकारे निर्विशेषे भिदाकुतः॥

Hence, despite the foremost exponent of *ajātavāda* the illustrious *ācārya* due to his munificence and compassion, in order to redeem his less gifted aspirants, preached the power and process of creation according to the Vedas as well as the agamas or tantras.

(English rendering by Brahmachari Paratpar Swarup)

Wisdom from Shiva's Rattle Drum

Swami Paranand Tirth



॥ जबगडदश् ॥ 10॥

The Tenth Aphorism

श्रोत्र त्वक् नयनघ्राण जिह्वादीन्द्रियपञ्चकम्
सर्वेषामपि जंतूनामीरितं जबगडदशा।

Nandikeshwara has followed what is called *Samhara Krama* or the order of dissolution to establish a mystic semblance between the aphorisms and their corresponding counterparts in the actual phenomena. The preceding beat had the origin of organs of action encrypted into it. In the order of pervasiveness and extension the description goes from gross to subtle. The domain of the organs of action is limited as compared to the domain of their perceptions. In the process of heading from gross to subtle the next in the order are the organs of action.

The tenth beat produces the five soft and delicate syllables

ज ब ग ड द ।

This is a very ingeniously devised process of creation and pervading the creation in the form of various gradations of divergence or convergence. First the all pervasive word emanating from the rattle drum of Shiva manifests in the form of senses of perception and then as the objects perceived through them. All the penta dimensional phenomena converges into these senses which go back into their constituents during the process of convergence and so edge into the form of reciprocations of the five dimensional objectivity .

To go back into their origin or source these senses must have steady flow of the current of awareness in them. The eternal word which first manifests in the form of these four beats of the divine rattle drum and then in the form of various categories of the phenomena. In order to trace back their origin there has to be steady and convergent flow of awareness. According to the methods of Vedanta, the awareness or consciousness which manifests as

sense perceptions of their respective senses are not different by one single consciousness is projected as conditioned in their respective senses. Likewise the phenomena subtler than this comprises the awareness as conditioned in various cognitive faculties as we shall discuss in the consequent aphorism. These five letters account for the creation and the power of perception of the five senses individually as well collectively. In the all pervasive antaryami these remain in a dormant form and after creating the cosmic being pervade him. The individual or the microcosm is an isomorphic replica of the cosmic being in whose case the entire process of evolution from a unicellular organism to the full fledged replica of the cosmic being is repeated firstly through an innate genetic semblance and secondly after the purificatory natal or post-natal sacraments of the individual soul . *Kenopanishada* tells us about the agency of the respective function of the senses. Decreed by whom does the mind imagine, spirit remains invigorates , senses like eyes ,ears and skins respond to their respective stimuli of soul touch, vision ,taste and smell .

श्रोत्रस्य श्रोत्रं मनसःमनोयत्।

Ear of the ear in ancient Vedic rhetoric means the agency of perception of sound in the ears. The all pervasive consciousness creates senses of perception, their presiding deities and unites them with their respective perceptions. These have their roots in Shiva as the creator -who signifies the *paravak* and his rattle drum the *pashyanti vak* which manifests as the undistinguished state of word and meaning. These beats emanate from this state of vak and get grosser as *madhyama* or the realm of individual and collective reason. Vaikhari the grossest state of vak has completely separate and unrelated word and meaning.

The rattle drum and it's beats denote *pashyanti* state and thus predates and outlasts dissolution. Whatever transcends the beginning and end of the universal phenomena comprising time, space and substance must be supra-mundane and eternal. An ancient school of grammarian mystics maintain that these fourteen beats and aphorisms are in fact revelations and even Shiva as a divine incarnation has not created them. He only made them available for the aspirants of the ultimate truth. As the propitiatory verse says

उद्धर्तुकामः सनकादिसिद्धान्

The main purpose was to redeem adepts like Sanaka etc. could not have been by teaching them grammar and then the Vedas and then finally the purport of the revelations. This speaks for the antiquity of the lineage of

their metaphysical meaning as compared to the lineage of its being the origin of dialectical and descriptive linguistics.

The revelations are meaningless when it comes to ascertain the power of creation without the knowledge of their meaning and purport. The system of grammar that evolved from these abbreviated aphorisms must be learnt in order to decipher the Vedic wisdom. So, in a metaphoric way even indirectly i.e. by understanding the Vedas through mastering the system of grammar caricatured on the edifice of these sutras, can be construed to mean as accrued from these sutras per se .

As the ancient system of reasoning has it, the one singular entity manifests in the form of these objects, means and process of perception individually as well as collectively. There are two modes of creation first in the form of word and in the form of their meaning. Both are inseparable from a Vedic perspective, word proceeds meaning in the context of Vedic Sanskrit and vice versa in classical Sanskrit. But either one of these two i.e. शाब्दी and आर्थी modes of creation must be there to explain the process of creation. The former has been proclaimed to precede the later by Nandikeshwara, since the eternal word converges into *Shabda Brahma* and all meaning remains dormant in it. This eternal word manifests as the beats of Shiva's drum and thus the gross creation that emanates from them. In the conventional Vedanta methods - presiding deities of directions , Vayu, Varun ,Surya,and Ashwini Kumar's account for various perceptions of the cosmic being . When these preside the sense organs of an individual and for that matter that of all creatures -the process of perception follows. There is another anecdote in the *Brihadaranyaka Upanishada* to support the argument that one single consciousness projects through the five sense organs to perceive five different stimuli. The mind unites with ear and the visual perception diminishes the man says mind was elsewhere or I was not attentive. This happens when the consciousness or mind is not able to focus on one particular sense organ. When one concentrates on one perception, other perceptions are a bit diminished. The unconditioned consciousness executes for the origin of the sense perception which as we have mentioned in earlier essays manifests in the form of the manifest or *avyaktam* , the cosmic reason or *mahat*, and the three-fold ego .The senses with mind intellect heart and ego plus the five sense perceptions spring forth from the satvic portion of *ahamkara*. Given that creation in the form of word and meaning emanates from the primordial word and the same primordial *Shabda Brahma* manifests in the form of beats from the lords rattle drum.

Each syllable of the beat i.e. ज,ब,ग, डand द accounts for the origin of ear, skin, eye, tongue and nose respectively.

There is an ancient theory of organic evolution which predates Darwin's theory and is consistent even in the context of latest theory of genetic evolution. It classifies all beings in the categories of insentient , semi-sentient, sentient , with and without mind , without reason and with reason, with or without vertebral column within developed or underdeveloped sense organs, and finally with mystically enhanced perceptions like extrasensory or supramental cognition which the doctrine yoga defines as *ritambhara prajna* * .Only highly evolved and adept yogins like Nandikeshwara could comprehend the mystic import of these aphoristic beats and a great devotee like Upamanyu could interpret the meaning to suit the understanding of a commoner. The great genetic evolution is repeated in the case of a human child. She can sync with the environment through his five sense organs and develop mentally as well intellectually according to the reciprocation of response and stimuli. The genetic evolution based on these is like a circle. Half of the mode is co-emergent and involves blending with pre-existing accumulation of conducive stimuli .This is through very accelerating means like the development of capability to read write, count and various other psychomotor cognitive faculties.The other half of the circle of genetic evolution starts with ketabolic changes in the physiology. The flow of awareness gets introvert and convenient. And finally heads towards the source i.e. the starting point in the circle of evolution. This is the point from where the unconditional consciousness gets diverget and thus grosser till equinox of absolute divergence is achieved. Without the momentum of spiritual impetus, one might as well get tangentially ousted and face the poignant plight of perpetrated eccentricity. A deliberate or motivated advance to the spontaneous course of convergence of the five perception into the mind and the time into reason which in turn merges back into its source and regulating principle i.e. begining point .

Shiva's best of the rattle drum are played at the end of his cosmic dance, the multitude that followed the stagnation of his seemingly perpetrated dynamism. The unalloyed pure subjective consciousness manifest as the beats of Shiva's rattle drum manifests as various components of the universal phenomena with all its reciprocation, during the course of divergence. During withdrawal or convergence part of the process,the entire phenomena converted into the five senses which in turn go back into

the tenth beat. All fourteen beats converge into the eternal silence which has been mystically named as अनच्कमहलं, the silence bereft of all vowels and components .

The great mystic significance of these aphorisms can be guessed from the devotion of highly learned grammarian of Kashi who would not use any Vedic or other mantra for adoring Shiva but poured water on his relic while reciting these aphorism, this as the heresy goes was the secret of his stupendous erudition .

To be continued.....

Endnote:

* The intuitive insight not based on conventional means of knowledge or perception and different from the conventional input of sensory stimulus into the cognitive system .

Pratyabhijna Hridayam Made Easy

Swami Paranand Tirth

The propitiatory verse

ॐ नमः मंगलमूर्तये

SALUTATIONS TO THE PERSONIFICATION OF AUSPICIOUSNESS

ॐ नमःशिवायसततं पंचकृत्य
विधायिने।चिदानंदघनस्वात्मपरमात्मावभासिने॥

Obeisance to Shiva who incessantly accomplishes the five functions viz. creation, sustenance and dissolution, relinquishing and redemption. Shiva reveals his essential nature which is consolidate- consciousness and bliss.

Like the elixir that was extracted during the churning of the ocean by demigods and demons. Kshema, the author and commentators of these sutras extracts the essence of Pratyabhijna ocean which in turn is the essence of Shankarite compendium of metaphysics (Upanishada). This elixir will pacify the venom of worldly existence.

Those desirous of unison with Parameshwara ,it can be made possible only by devotion and Shaktipat -a mystic induction of spiritual power . This *Ishvara Pratyabhijna* is revealed to such devout aspirants, even though they have no erudition in logic because of their meagre intellectual competence. The power of consciousness as the universal self is the sole agency of causation,is easy to attain and results in great fruition..

Hence the first aphorism

चितिःस्वतंत्रा विश्वसिद्धिहेतुः
chitihswatantravishwasidhihetuh

Questions relating to the propitiatory verses:

1. Why are the five functions repeated incessantly?
2. Essential nature should not have any attributes, so why consolidate consciousness, bliss etc?
3. If Shiva reveals his essential nature himself what about the means?
4. Is this the same Upanishads that we study in Vedanta ?
5. Why are this *sansara* / worldly existence venomous?
6. How does the panacea of *pratyabhijna* or the recognition of the universal self ,pacify it i.e. the venom of *samsara* ?

(Sutra 1)

चितिःस्वतंत्रा विश्वसिद्धिहेतुः॥१॥

chitihswatantravishwsidhihetuh

(Translation): The power of consciousness accounts for creation etc. independently

(Exposition):

Visva Siddhi- is the process of universal manifestation comprising thirty six /thirty five elements .Some translators mean the accomplishing of all five fold functions attributed to Param Shiva viz. creation, sustenance, dissolution and redemption .

Swatantryam or independence ,redefined-

The power of consciousness is swatantryam .Swatantra has been defined as the nature of ultimate gnosis –“Anuttara vimarsha” and thus is ever in eternal unison with Param Shiva within which she herself manifests as the universe, sustains and dissolves it. This can be experienced only subjectively .The objective experience pertaining to insentient and essence-less maya or prakriti can not be the cause or hetu. On the other hand, the self-luminous entity or prakash itself is the cue owing to the unison of the universal phenomena with prakash. So, Chiti the transcendent entity alone accounts for the power and process of creation and is not something conditioned in time and space but is born from it and is sustained by it. The universe is not something different from the Chiti so how can these two be the cause and effect. The Goddess of consciousness projects herself in the form of infinitesimal universal phenomena hence the cause and effect relationship is consistent. Moreover she accounts for the appearance of this universe divisible in the form of experience, experiencing and experienced. Therefore no testimony of evidence is fit or needed for proving her because she is free, unconditioned and self evident. All proofs are required to vindicate some new entity.

Trika Shastra tells us the analogy of the futility of a man who tries to jump over the shadow of his own head. Likewise the bindu-kala the transcendental dot which is beyond the range of will, wisdom and work trio[jnana,ichhca and kriya] cannot be transcended by any effort- actual or contemplative. Since this power of consciousness accounts for the process of creation and also dissolution which is in the form of the transcendental non-dual homogeneity she is free and independent. Once her independent nature has been established, she accomplishes both emancipation and enjoyments (bhoga and moksha) .This is yet another rendering of the term Vishwam .

Since Chiti accounts for the creation and dissolution of the phenomenon as not different from Pure Consciousness (Samrasya is homogeneity with the non-dual principle)- she is called Swatantra or ‘Free Will’. Hence due

to her virtue of being Swantantra- free- she is the agency accomplishing *bhoga* and *moksha* both.

There is a famous saying among the devotees of *chitshakti* .

“Yatrastibhogi nahi tatra moksha, yatrasti moksha nahi tatra bhogah
Shri sundarisevantatparanambhuktishchmuktischkarasthev”

“One can not have the cake and eat it too . If enjoyments, no emancipation; if emancipation no enjoyments. But a worshiper of the divine mother can accomplish both concomitantly.”

Kshemraja while commenting on his own aphorisms gives an alternate meaning of the word *vishvam* – *bhog* and *moksha* . She is free, so she can emancipate her aspirants even as enjoying worldly pleasures and she can also provide worldly enjoyments to her aspirants even while they are pennant and engaged in moderation. Yet another meaning of the word *Vishvam* i.e. entirety pertains to a more subjective perspective both explicit as well as implicit. In the lingo of the Agamas, the world or the complete objective whole has been acrimoniously defined as, *sukha*, *prana*, *neela* etc. This is presumably an undermining of the conventional phenomena to facilitate its transcendence. So the term *Visvam* in this version of interpretation is the entire phenomena consisting of body, joy, perceptions like blue, *prana*-vital airs etc. The divergence of awareness from absolute subjective consciousness to various gradations of objectivity accounts for the special phenomena called *unmeelanam* or unfolding. The order of awareness descends from *Pramata* [experiencer] to *Pramana*[experiencing] to *Prameya* [object of experience].

This term *Chitih* is very significant when it comes to defining ‘consciousness’ by modern cognitive scientists. Consciousness, the sentience in ancient life science used to be defined as the agency that accounts for functions like, respiration, locomotion, reproduction and a few more motor activities. This however refers to it as an objective entity and to be cognised in only the subject under study. Eastern metaphysics enunciates the subjective portion of the consciousness usually referred to as *Pramata* who in its conditioned form comes to be called *Aparpramata* or *Maya-pramata* i.e. inferior experiencer , or *Parichhinna-pramta* or the empirical experiencer so on and so forth. *Chiti* is derived from a root *chiti sajnanne* which means to know or to cognise. In this aphorism the power of consciousness or *chitashakti* is explained.

There are two streamlines of consciousness – a layman’s and a yogin’s . Object and subject difference is same to both, but Yogins are conscious of the subject and object relationship. The latter is not acquired just by learning. One is supposed to get it first hand when one actually meditates and tallies with his experiences. An uninitiated person who has not yet learnt about his spiritual existence beyond the body, mind and

senses perceives the world only through his limited vision and is oblivious of the perceiver and the process of perception.

A yogi as per an often quoted canto of the tantras also shares a conventional view point of the layman but at the same time does not lose sight of this identity and unison with the ultimate seer or Param Shiva. He further descends to various levels of proportions of seer and seeing and at the same time maintain the awareness of his ultimate identity .

Even if a yogi is engaged in every detail of the exterior gross sense objects he doesn't lose sight of his unison with Brahman the absolute just as a dancer use even while maintaining an awareness of rhythm, beat, tune and steps does not lose the sight of a pitcher or a trail of pitchers balanced on her head .

The term Chiti has been used as singular .This rules out any other entity intellectual or actual. Her dual and multiple aspects are also refuted by this use of singular for *chitih*.

Swatantryam or Independence ,redefined-

Since Chiti accounts for the creation and dissolution of the phenomenon as not different from Pure Consciousness (Samrasya is homogeneity with the non-dual principle)- she is called swatantra or 'Free Will'. Hence due to her virtue of being swatantra- free- she is the agency of accomplishing bhoga and moksha both. Independence is the virtue of not depending on any other entity for accomplishing some objective in this parlance the five-fold function of the universal phenomena .This swatantryam which we have defined as free-will must not be confused with the talks of yes or no to free-will that is prevalent these days . Even from a metaphysical stand point "free-will" is not consistent as *a priori* of creation or unfolding of the phenomena sine the apparatus of will are yet to manifest . The power of consciousness as the ultimate entity is visualised by aspirants of grosser view point as the divine mother

Seated on a dais with four legs as Brahma, Vishnu ,Rudra Ishwara and Sadashiva as the plank ,she decrees these five deities for their respective actions . She on the other hand is not under any other entity's subordination. This is the essential meaning of the term swatantra . There is a popular *suktam* in the Rigveda called *Atmasuktam* or *Devi suktam* . The power of consciousness or chitshkti dawned upon a seer's daughter called Vagambhrini and she unveiled her mystic secrets in the form of a *suktam* .

I blow unrestricted like wind as I create multiple
realms of the cosmos .

With my divine magnanimity and infinite expanse –

I transcend the earth ,sky , the space , the entire cosmos.

I pervade this entire universe with my body .

[*Devi suktam*]

In the beginning Kshemraja has mentioned that this *Pratyabhijna hridayam* is the essence of the Shavite Upanishadas presumably *ishwara pratyabhijna* to befit the competence of mediocre aspirants who have no erudition in syllogism and grammar but are full of faith and devotion and through faith and devotion who have received the induction of the power of consciousness and are able to recognise their unison with ultimate Shiva or Shakti which are not different from one another .

Since *Chiti* is used as a singular not conditioned by time and space, the system advocates a form of Monism which refutes all the dualistic theories. The word ‘Svatnatra’ used with ‘*Chiti*’ essentially stresses the point that Chiti is independent of any other entity and hence is free-will unlike the doctrine of Brahman proposed by Shankara Vedanta in which *Cit* is considered to be inactive. The Sutra further suggests that due to the unlimited will of Chiti that the entire phenomena is seen to be unfolded and if one realises the power of Chiti in its true sense then the path to emancipation is not far.

The term ‘Vishvam’ etc. also refers to the state of being endowed with all Shaktis, the universal cause, attainability without any discomfort and granting the greatest fruit that is emancipation. If Chiti is the primordial cause of the universe, she must also be the fundamental or instrumental cause so duality cannot be ruled out.

To answer this interjection the following aphorism goes as
‘ SvechhayaSvabhitauVisvamUnmilayati’

Plz visit our website www.yogatantragama.org. Study circle. Or Yog Tantra Agama google classroom. To post your answers

To be continued.....

Kalki: The Warrior-Avatāra in the Kālachakra Tantra

Niraj Kumar

The Sanskrit word *kalka*(कल्क) has the meaning of foulness or filth. One can see the example of the black glue-like sedimented waste in the clogged drains and the sinkholes. Various type of waste goes into drain and in due course of time; all decompose into waste material of same colour and nature, glued together. Even when one puts unrefined oil in bottles, similar

viscous sediment is deposited at the base. All such are examples of Kalkha(कल्क). When fire burns, the shoot leaves behind the black mark, termed kalikha(कालिख). In fact, the concept of Kalka was one of the primary theme in the great Indian epic, *Mahabharata*. There are 18 books(Parva) in the Mahabharata. Each Parva has thence sub-sections. *Anukramaniparva* is the first of the 100 Upa-Parvas (Sections), contained in AdiParva, the first book of the Mahabharata. As per the BORI edition, *Anukramaniparva* has a total of 210 Shlokas. The last verse of the *Anukramaniparva* sums up the message of the *Mahabharata* itself:

तपो न कल्कोऽध्ययनं न कल्कः; स्वाभाविको वेदविधिर्न कल्कः ।

प्रसह्य वित्ताहरणं न कल्कः; स्तान्येव भावोपहतानि कल्कः ॥२१०॥

tapo na kalko'dhyayanam na kalkaḥ; svābhāviko vedavidhirna kalkaḥ |

prasahya vittāharaṇam na kalka; stānyeva bhāvopahatāni kalkaḥ
||210||

(Mahabharat, First Book आदिपर्वम् || First Section अनुक्रमणीपर्व ,
Last Verse in the Critical Edition of *Mahabharata*, published
by Bhandarkar Oriental Research Institute).

Translation: Tapa is without filth, study is without filth, the prescriptions of the Vedas are without filth, the acquisition of wealth by exertion is not sinful; but when these are struck by infatuation in their practices, it is then that they become sin and evil.

The *Mahabharata* thus sums up the message of rightful living as practising moderation in pursuit. It is akin to the Middle path propounded by Buddha. Excess always produce residue. If the Kaliyuga is a time frame depicting excess of greed and consumption, the residue would again be the Kalka.

Kalachakra Tantra was composed during the first half of the 11th century. Advent of Kalki is a major theme in this Tantra. Kalki is personification of this Kalka, the residue of a time-flow. Buddhist Kalki(कल्कि) is quite different from the Hinduized Kalki of the Purana literature composed during the same period. While both streams, Hindu and Buddhist, assume the Kalki to be the tenth and the last avatara of Vishnu in the place of *Shambhal* ,the similarity ends here. Kalki in the Vaishnava tradition is supposed to be the son of Viṣṇuśāśa, a Brahmin who will fight against the *Mlecchas* (lowest class of people) polluting the dharma. Kalki would give the deliverance from the Kaliyuga and herald the new age of the Kṛta

Yuga(Satayuga) by exterminating the sinners, and restoring dharma. Kalki would establish the *cāturvarṇa*(Four Varna system) and the four *āśramas*. Hindu Kalki is a Brahmanical hero. There is no theoretical formulation for postulating the new reincarnation of Vishnu in the form of Kalki.

In the Kalachakra tradition, Kalki is exactly opposite. He is not for the purity of races. Buddhist Kalki is all for mixing of races. And how many races? It is 96. Buddhist Kalki is conceptually derived from mathematics. It is all based on geometrical and trigonometrical understanding. In a circle/ wheel(Chakra), there are a total of 360^0 . There are four quadrants of 90^0 each. In each quadrant, Indian mathematicians calculated 24 sine (*jya*) values. Thus, a total of 96 *jya* values were tabulated within a circle. Number 96 connotes this wholeness of circle, while number 24 only for a quadrant. In the time of Buddhist Kalki, Kalachakra Tantra mentions, the height of human beings would be 96 digits (angula- or finger-length). Even the age of human beings in the Kaliyuga will actually be only 96 years and thereafter the Kalachakra days of 1125days (3 years, 3 fortnights and 3 lagnas) would unfold in a human lifespan of 100 years. Thus, the concept of Kalachakran Kalki is deeply enmeshed with the mathematical knowledge about the circle(chakra/wheel).

Not only that, Kalki is assumed to be equivalent to the “remainder”, the left-out of mathematical process of division of a quantity. Whole of the Kalachakra Tantra can be seen as engagement with the “remainders”. The values of planetary positions are calculated based upon the remainder. It is not the value of quotient, but what is left behind, the remainder which are actually the exact values in Kalachakran astronomy. An example of such calculation is given below:

Suppose one has to find the day of the week.

If the total sum of week-value(Vaar-pinda/वार पिण्ड) is, say, 38. Now dividing it by 7(number of days in a week), one obtains a quotient of 5 and remainder 3. Remainder 3 is the weekday. Number 0 is the Sunday. Then number 3 corresponds to Wednesday.

Clearly the remainder is indivisible. Division in Sanskrit is termed as “Hata”(हत). Hata also is homonym for death. Remainder is *Anahata*(अनाहत), indivisible. *Anahata* is also indestructible. Kalachakra Tantra, in its quest for indestructibility of body (*Vajradeha*) and indestructibility of the territory(*Buddha-kshetra*) indulges with remainders and leftover in different facet of existence.

There is Kala-agni(the cosmic fire) which is the remainder left behind after reabsorption of the whole universe. Among the nadis, the Dhananjaya nadi is the remainder even after death of an individual. Kalki is akin to what is left behind in the Kaliyuga, the indestructible Dharma-warrior. Kalki of the Kalachakra Tantra is like the paste where individuality of components are lost and everything assumes a universal flavour(samarasa). Kalki is thus assumed to be celebrating the leftover of the caste system. In the Kalachakra Tantra, the whole hierarchy of caste system is reversed and it is Shudras which are celebrated at the highest pedestal of the caste hierarchy. Shudras propitiate Goddess Tara and it is from Tara of Kamakhya that the whole hierarchy of 36 Goddesses begin.

Thus, from mathematics to geometry to cosmogony and empirical physical sciences, the concept of “remainder” was extracted and formulated as a theoretical construct personified as Kalki, which is assumed as indestructible with universal flavour(samarasa/समरस). Clearly, Buddhist Kalki is against caste hierarchy and hence has not been described as a Brahmin. On the other hand, Brahmanical conception of Kalki is crude and his role is to re-establish the Varna system. Buddhist Kalki celebrates the fusion and mixing, Brahmanical Kalki is for segregation and purity.

Both, Brahmanical and Buddhist Kalki are assumed to be the last of Vishnu's Daśāvatāras.

Mahabharatra (Vana Parva, Markandeya-Samasya Upa-parva,190.93-97) adds to the description of Kalki's appearance:

कल्किर विष्णुयशा नाम दविजः कालप्रचोदितः
उत्पत्स्यते महावीर्यो महाबुद्धिपराक्रमः

संभूतः संभल गरामे बराह्मणावसथे शुभे
मनसा तस्य सर्वाणि वाहनान्य आयुधानि च
उपस्थास्यन्ति योधाश्च शस्त्राणि कवचानि च

स धर्मविजयी राजा चक्रवर्ती भविष्यति
स चेमं संकुलं लोकं परसादम उपनेष्यति

उत्थितो बराह्मणो दीप्तः कषयान्तकृद उदारधीः
स संक्षेपो हि सर्वस्य युगस्य परिवर्तकः

स सर्वत्रगतान कषुद्रान बराह्मणैः परिवारितः
उत्सादयिष्यति तदा सर्वान मलेच्छ गणान दविजः

kalkira viṣṇuyaśā nāma davijah kālpracoditaḥ
utpatsyate mahāvīryo mahābuddhiparākramaḥ

saṁbhūtaḥ saṁbhala garāme barāhmaṇāvasathe śubhe
manasā tasya sarvāṇi vāhanānya āyudhāni ca
upasthāsyanti yodhāśa ca śāstrāṇi kavacāni ca

sa dharmavijayī rājā cakravartī bhaviṣyati
sa cemaṁ saṁkulaṁ lokaṁ parasādama upaneṣyati

utthitao barāhmaṇo dīptaḥ kaṣayāntakṛda udāradhīḥ
sa saṁkṣepo hi sarvasya yugasya parivartakaḥ

“...a Brahmana by the name of *Kalki* will take his birth. And he will glorify Vishnu and possess great energy, great intelligence, and great prowess. And he will take his birth in a town of the name of *Sambhala* in an auspicious Brahmana family. And vehicles and weapons, and warriors and arms, and coats of mail will be at his disposal as soon as he will think of them. And he will be the king of kings, and ever victorious with the strength of virtue. And he will restore order and peace in this world crowded with creatures and contradictory in its course. And that blazing Brahmana of mighty intellect, having appeared, will destroy all things. And he will be the Destroyer of all, and will inaugurate a new *Yuga*. And surrounded by the Brahmans, that Brahmana will exterminate all the *mlecchas* wherever those low and despicable persons may take refuge.”

(K.M. Ganguli English translation of the Mahabharata, The *Mahabharatra* (*Vana Parva*, 190.93-97).

In same section of the Mahabharata, it is mentioned that Kalki would be born when Jupiter, Sun and Moon would be in the *Pushya* (3.20⁰ Cancer-16.40⁰ Cancer) constellation. Thus, his date of birth would fall sometimes in the month of July. This constellation comprises of three stars and considered as ruled by the planet Jupiter. The name *Pushya*, itself, is derived from the Sanskrit root '*pushti*' or nourishment. The arrangement of stars of the Pushya constellation resemble a cow's udder (*Go-stana*), again indicating the nourishment. Kalki is thus assumed as byproduct of nourishment, rather scarcity.

In the Mahabharata, Kalki as an avatar was formulated without mention of Buddha. Wendy Doniger deciphers that this might be a reaction against the invasion of India by the Greeks, Scythians. Kushanas and Pahlavas. (*The Origin of Evil in Hindu Mythology*, 1976, p. 200). She mentions that even this might be an adoption of Maitreya myth prevalent among the Buddhists.

Chapter 16 of the *Agni Purāṇa*, describes the Brahmanical Kalki in following words:

“At that time, there will be intermixture of castes. People will become thieves and evil doers. Fifteen divisions of the Veda Vājasaneyā alone will become the authoritative document. People, wearing the garb of righteousness, will indulge in unrighteousness. Mlecchas (lowest class of people) assuming the form of Kings will begin feeding upon human beings. At that time Lord Viṣṇu will incarnate as Kalki, the son of Viṣṇuśāśas and the priest of Yājñavalkya and exterminate all mlecchas. He will restore people to cāturvarṇya and the four āśramas and maintain proper standards of conduct. Afterwards the Lord will renounce the form of Kalki and ascend Heaven. Then Kṛtayuga will begin again.”

Kalki in Kalachakra Tantra is said to be born in *Sam̐bhala*. Kalki of the Kalachakra tantra leads the army of 96 regions against the barbarian prophet. He seeks assistance from Hindu gods like Śiva, Viṣṇu, Gaṇeśa and Hanuman. He is one who binds people. He makes all of one caste. He lives and practises in the world of everyday lives. He boasts of children. After establishing the dharma, he does not stick to power, and hands over the authorities to successor and goes back to another section of the earth to establish the dharma. Thus, he transcends greed and desire. This section also depicts him as someone who has double-nature. Though, Kalki is humble and bestows peace and happiness to the righteous people, he is ferocious against the wicked people. Unlike the Hindu Kalki avatar who is said to carry a sword riding a white horse, the Kalki of Kalachakra carries a small spear in hand. Kalki of Kalachakra possesses 12 characteristics that include a consort, virility, divine languages, wisdom, eye ointment (anjana is shoot deposited from burning flame), and an eagle. While Kalki of Purāṇa possesses a parrot, the warrior nature of Kalki of Kalachakra is made explicit with selection of his emblems. Kalachakran Kalki has eagle (garuda), the king of birds. Moreover Kalki of Kalachakra is more anthropic. He is born when life span of human beings is 100 years. He lives for 50 years after establishing the dharma and departs to his own place after handing over the reign to his successors.

Kalki of Kalachakra represents the double principle of evam(एवं) and ekam(एकं) i.e. principle of similarity and Oneness. He brings diverse world-views at one place and creates a common world-view which is universal and acceptable. Unlike other world-views of its own time, where emphasis on own truth, own God, was pervasive; Kalki stands for the principle of globalization where different world views could share common umbrella. This global principle was also homogenous in nature. In a way, it was a refreshing theory of globalization emanating just before the first wave of globalization under the Mongols who had become fervent adherent of the Kalachakra philosophy through Tibetan mediators.

The focus of Kalachakra philosophy is on hybridization and homogenization. Hybridization is unlike Greek chimera where separate nature remained manifest. Here, hybrids lose svabhava(स्वभाव) and partake common nature just as in Kalka(paste). This was indeed the first major philosophy of globalization. Kalki became personification of this grand universal spirit of coming together of mankind forsaking wickedness.

Kalki emerges only after the stage of nourishment of mankind is fulfilled. Beyond nourishment(Poshan, पोषण) lies the satisfaction(Toshan, तोषण). Toshan is realized when samarasa(समरस), the universal flavour is produced. This is done through the process of piercing by the residue of the killing process in alchemy. Similarly, Kalki pierces(Vedhana, वेधन) the world and brings about transmutation unto a world of contentment. Buddhist Kalki thus also operates through established process of alchemy for transmutation of mankind.

Famous Bhakti-poet Jayadeva in his 12th century composition *Gita-Govinda*, refers to the Kalki Avatāra :

म्लेच्छनिवहनिधने कलयसिकरवालम् । धूमकेतुमिव किमपिकरालम्॥

केशव धृतकल्किशरीर जयजगदीशहरे॥ अ प १-१०

पदच्छेद : म्लेच्छ निवह निधने कलयसि करवालम् धूम केतुम् इव

किम् अपि करालम् केशव धृत कल्कि शरीर जय जगदीश हरे

[mlecchanivahanidhane kalayasikaravālam । dhūmaketumiva kimapikarālam॥

keśava dhṛtakalkiśārīra jayajagadīśahare॥

padaccheda : mleccha nivaha nidhane kalayasi karavālam dhūma ketum iva
[kim api karālam keśava dhṛta kalki śārīra jaya jagadīśa hare]

(*Trans:* Assuming the form of Kalki at the end of Kali yuga, O, Keshava, you will be brandishing a comet like sword to eliminate the groups of fractious races, and unimaginable are your horrendous deeds to detail, hence oh, Hari, you are the Almighty of worlds, thus hail to thee...

The appearance of a comet in the sky is a bad omen and when that comet hits the earth it is still worse. And when Kalki brandishes his sword as gods brandish comets, it is unimaginable and that suggests the end of that era. Desiraju Hanumanta Rao; Revised 2008)

Dhuma-ketu and Dhuma(smoke) are eulogized in the Kalachakra Tantra,too. Dhuma is the sign of approach of death for an individual and similarly appearance of Dhuma-ketu, a sign for the coming apocalyptic war and end of the Kaliyuga. The inner yogic path has been described as the Dhuma-adi marga(धूमादि मार्ग).The signs that appear to a yogi on path of realization again begins from the Dhuma.

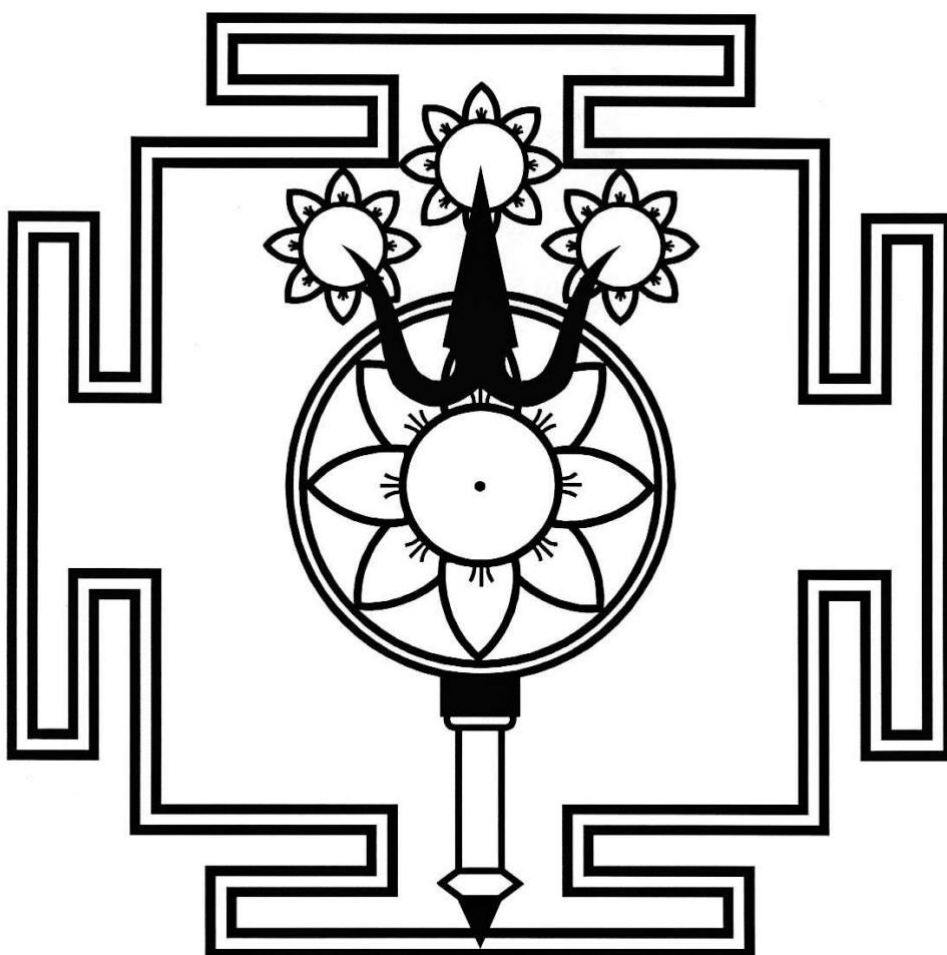
Dhuma is again the residue of fire. Kalki is the indestructible residue of the excessive indulgences of prosperity of the Kaliyuga as beautifully summed up in the first section of the Mahabharata.

In the famous 11th century Simhachalam temple(Vishakhapatnam) of the Vaishnavite sect, the deity Narasimha(chimera of human and lion) is further hybridised with another incarnation of Vishnu, *Varaha* so that the wrath of Narasimha could be diluted. The Simhachalam temple complex which appears as a three-layered rectangular Kalchakra mandala built around the emergence of the Kalachakra Tantra has statue of Kalki riding on horse. Just as fusions have been practised in the different religious groups in India, it is likely that an Indic Kalki would be a fusion of the Vaishnava and Buddhist imaginations.

(*Niraj Kumar* has written on Hindu and Buddhist Tantras. His forthcoming work is on *Kalachakra Tantra*. He lives in New Delhi, India.)



Pic: Swami Paranand Ji Maharaj and Kumaraswami inaugurating the YTA Colloquium at the The Resorts, BPTP Greater Faridabad December 2019



YTA Yoga Tantra and Agama(Inc)

Published by
 Paranand Swami
 F-1602, The Resorts
 BPTP Greater Faridabad
 Haryana .India .121002.
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